



Nurtura

Getting Started on iPhone Simulator

A step-by-step walkthrough to run the Nurtura iOS app on your Mac. No prior mobile dev experience needed.

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What You Need Before Starting

Before we begin, make sure you have these four things installed on your Mac. If you're missing any, follow the links to get them.

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES	HOW TO GET IT
Xcode	Apple's app-building tool. Includes the iPhone Simulator.	Mac App Store → search "Xcode" → Install (it's free, but ~12GB)
Node.js 18+	Runs JavaScript on your computer (our app is built with it).	<code>brew install node</code> or nodejs.org
npm	Installs packages (libraries) our app needs. Comes with Node.js.	Included with Node.js
Git	Downloads code from GitHub.	<code>brew install git</code> or Xcode installs it automatically



How to check if you have them

Open Terminal (press `Cmd + Space`, type "Terminal", hit Enter) and run:

```
node --version      # Should say v18 or higher
npm --version       # Should say 9 or higher
git --version        # Any version is fine
xcode-select -p      # Should print a path like /Applications/Xcode.app/...
```



Step 0 — Fix the Yarn PnP Problem

There's a sneaky file on your Mac that messes up how packages get loaded. This is the **#1 thing blocking the app from running**. Let's fix it first.

1

Check if the problem file exists

```
ls -la ~/.pnp.cjs ~/.pnp.loader.mjs 2>/dev/null
```

If you see file info, the problem file exists. If you see nothing, skip to the next section — you're already fine!

2

Rename it (safe & reversible)

```
mv ~/.pnp.cjs ~/.pnp.cjs.bak  
mv ~/.pnp.loader.mjs ~/.pnp.loader.mjs.bak 2>/dev/null
```

This doesn't delete anything — it just renames the files so they stop interfering. If something else breaks, you can rename them back.

What is this file?

It's a Yarn "Plug'n'Play" manifest — probably created by accidentally running `yarn` in your home folder. It tells every project on your Mac to use Yarn's special module system instead of the normal `node_modules` folder. We don't want that.



Step 1 — Get the Code

1

Open Terminal

Press `Cmd + Space`, type **Terminal**, press Enter.

2

Go to where you want the project

```
cd ~
```

This puts you in your home folder. The project will live at `~/nurtura-ios`.

3

Download the code from GitHub

```
git clone https://github.com/XtianBDevn/nurtura-ios.git  
cd nurtura-ios
```

Already have it? Just pull the latest changes instead:

```
cd ~/nurtura-ios  
git pull origin main
```



Step 2 — Install Everything

Now we install all the libraries (packages) the app needs. This only takes a minute.

1

Clean out any old installs

```
rm -rf node_modules  
rm -f yarn.lock .pnp.cjs .pnp.loader.mjs
```

This makes sure we start fresh. If you've never run the project before, this does nothing — that's fine.

2

Install with npm

```
npm install
```

This downloads everything into a `node_modules` folder. Wait until it says "added XXX packages." Ignore any yellow "WARN" messages — those are usually harmless.

Don't use yarn!

Always use `npm install`, never `yarn`. Yarn's PnP mode conflicts with Convex's bundler. Stick to npm for this project.

Step 3 — Set Up Your Environment File

The app needs to know where its backend server is. That info lives in a tiny file called `.env`.

1 Check if `.env` already exists

```
cat .env
```

If you see `EXP0_PUBLIC_CONVEX_URL=https://...`, you're good — skip to Step 4.

2 If it doesn't exist, create it

```
cp .env.example .env
```

Or if you ran `npx convex dev` and it created `.env.local`, that works too — Expo reads both.

Which Convex deployment am I using?

DEPLOYMENT	URL	WHEN TO USE
Production (shared with web app)	<code>https://capable-stork-178.convex.cloud</code>	Testing against live data
Dev (your own)	<code>https://successful-shrimp-557.convex.cloud</code>	Experimenting safely

For first-time testing, use the **Dev** deployment so you don't accidentally change production data.

Step 4 — Start the Convex Backend

Convex is the backend (database + server). It needs to be running for the app to load data.

1 Open a terminal tab for Convex

Press `Cmd + T` in Terminal to open a new tab. Navigate to the project:

```
cd ~/nurtura-ios
npx convex dev
```

First time? It'll ask you to log in — follow the prompts. It'll open a browser window where you sign into Convex.

2 Wait for the green checkmark

You should see something like:

```
✓ Synced functions
| Watching for file changes...
```

That means Convex is running! **Leave this tab open** — Convex needs to keep running.

If you see "Could not resolve convex/server"

This means the Yarn PnP file is still interfering. Go back to **Step 0** and make sure you renamed `~/ .pnp.cjs`. Then run `rm -rf node_modules && npm install` again.



Step 5 — Start the App

1

Open another terminal tab

Press `Cmd + T` again. You now have two tabs: one running Convex, one for Expo.

```
cd ~/nurtura-ios  
npx expo start
```

2

You'll see a menu like this

```
› Metro waiting on exp://192.168.x.x:8081  
› Scan the QR code above with Expo Go (Android) or the Camera app (iOS)  
  
› Using Expo Go  
› Press s | switch to development build  
› Press i | open iOS simulator  
› Press w | open web  
› Press r | reload app  
› Press j | open debugger
```

3

Press `i` to open the iPhone Simulator

This launches a virtual iPhone on your screen. It may take 30—60 seconds the first time (the simulator is booting).

⚠️ If you get "Operation timed out" (error code 60)

The simulator was too slow to boot. Try these fixes in order:

Fix A: Wait for the simulator to fully show the Home Screen, then press `i` again in Terminal.

Fix B: Restart the simulator completely:

```
xcrun simctl shutdown all  
npx expo start --ios
```

Fix C: Use your real iPhone instead (see Step 6 below).

➡️ Step 6 — Run on Your Real iPhone (Optional)

Don't want to use the simulator? Run it on your actual phone with Expo Go.

1

Download Expo Go

Open the App Store on your iPhone and search for "**Expo Go**". Install it (it's free).

2

Create an Expo account (if you don't have one)

Go to expo.dev/signup and create a free account. Then log in on your phone.

3

Make sure your Mac and iPhone are on the same Wi-Fi

They need to be on the same network to talk to each other.

4

Scan the QR code

In Terminal where Expo is running, you'll see a big QR code. Open the **Camera** app on your iPhone and point it at the QR code. Tap the banner that says "Open in Expo Go."



Expo Go Credentials

You can use any email/password to create an Expo account — it's separate from the app's login. Expo Go is just the "shell" that runs your app during development.



Step 7 — Create a Test Account & Log In

The app uses **email + password** authentication powered by Convex. There are no pre-made test accounts — you'll create your own.

Creating a New Account

1

Tap "Start Free →" on the landing screen

This takes you to the Sign Up page.

2

Fill in your details

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Name	Any name (e.g., <code>Chris Test</code>)
Email	Any email (e.g., <code>test@test.com</code>)
Password	At least 6 characters (e.g., <code>test123</code>)

3

Tap "Create Account"

If everything works, you'll be taken to the Onboarding flow.



Recommended Test Credentials

Keep it simple — use these so you always remember:

Email: `test@nurtura.app`
Password: `nurtura123`

These only exist on YOUR Convex deployment. Nobody else can see them.

Logging In Later

1

Tap "Log In" on the landing screen

Enter the email and password you used to sign up. Tap "Sign In."



Step 8 — What Each Screen Does

After signing up, here's the journey through the app:

Onboarding (6 steps — only shows once)

Step 0 — Role Selection

Choose "Professional Caregiver" or "Family Caregiver." This changes what features you see.

Step 1 — Your Profile

Enter your name and phone number.

Step 2 — Display & Accessibility

Pick your age group and text size. If you pick "65+", the app uses bigger buttons and text.

Step 3 — Care Recipient

Add the person you're caring for — name, age, conditions, etc.

Step 4 — Meet Ivy

Ivy is the AI assistant. She introduces herself with a typing animation. Just tap "Continue."

Step 5 — All Set!

Confetti! Tap "Enter Nurtura" to go to the main app.

Main App (5 tabs at the bottom)

Home (Dashboard)

Overview cards: recent care logs, upcoming meds, next appointment, unread messages. Your daily hub.

Care (Recipients)

List of people you care for. Tap one to see their profile, conditions, and care history.

Log

Add care log entries — meals, medications, activities, mood, notes. The core daily record.

Schedule

Calendar view of appointments, medication times, and shift schedules.

More

Settings, profile, subscription tier, and Sign Out button.

Testing Checklist

Use this checklist to make sure everything works. Go through each item and check it off:

Launch & Auth

- ☐ App opens to the landing screen (green logo, "Care, naturally" tagline)
- ☐ Tapping "Start Free →" goes to Sign Up
- ☐ Can create a new account with email + password
- ☐ After sign up, onboarding starts automatically
- ☐ Can log out (More tab → Sign Out)
- ☐ Can log back in with the same credentials

Onboarding

- ☐ Role selection works (Professional vs Family)
- ☐ Profile step accepts name and phone
- ☐ Accessibility step lets you pick age group and text size
- ☐ Care recipient step lets you add someone
- ☐ Ivy animation plays smoothly
- ☐ Confetti appears on the final step

Main Tabs

- ☐ Home tab shows dashboard cards
- ☐ Care tab shows recipient list (should have the one you added)

- ☐ Log tab lets you create a new care entry
- ☐ Schedule tab shows calendar view
- ☐ More tab shows settings and profile
- ☐ Tab switching feels smooth (no freezing)

Performance

- ☐ No crash on launch
- ☐ Scrolling is smooth
- ☐ Keyboard appears and dismisses properly
- ☐ Dark mode works (toggle in iOS Settings → Display)
- ☐ Back navigation works correctly



Troubleshooting — Common Problems

PROBLEM	CAUSE	FIX
"Could not resolve convex/server"	Yarn PnP file at <code>~/ .pnp.cjs</code>	<code>mv ~/.pnp.cjs ~/.pnp.cjs.bak</code> then <code>rm -rf node_modules && npm install</code>
"expo-asset cannot be found"	Missing dependency	<code>npm install expo-asset</code>
Simulator timeout (code 60)	Simulator was still booting	Wait for Home Screen, then press <code>i</code> again
"Login Failed" alert	Wrong credentials or Convex not running	Check Convex tab is running. Try signing up a new account.
Blank white screen	Convex backend not connected	Check <code>.env</code> has the right <code>EXPO_PUBLIC_CONVEX_URL</code> . Restart Expo.
App loads but no data	Using a fresh Convex deployment with no data	Normal! Sign up and go through onboarding to create data.



Quick Reference Card

Terminal Commands (Copy & Paste)

First Time Setup

```
# 1. Fix PnP
mv ~/.pnp.cjs ~/.pnp.cjs.bak 2>/dev/null

# 2. Clone
git clone https://github.com/XtianBDevn/nurtura-ios.git
cd nurtura-ios

# 3. Install
npm install

# 4. Start Convex (Tab 1)
npx convex dev

# 5. Start Expo (Tab 2)
npx expo start

# 6. Press 'i' to open simulator
```

Daily Development

```
cd ~/nurtura-ios

# Tab 1: Backend
npx convex dev

# Tab 2: App
npx expo start
# Press 'i' for simulator, or scan QR for phone
```

After Pulling Updates

```
git pull origin main
rm -rf node_modules
npm install
# Restart Convex and Expo
```

Important URLs

WHAT	URL
GitHub Repo	github.com/XtianBDevn/nurtura-ios
Convex Dashboard (Dev)	dashboard.convex.dev/d/successful-shrimp-557
Convex Dashboard (Prod)	dashboard.convex.dev → capable-stork-178
Nurtura Web App	carecircle-f5d61241.viktor.space
Expo Dev Portal	expo.dev

Project Structure (What's What)

```
nurtura-ios/
├─ app/                ← All the screens you see
│   ├─ index.tsx       ← Landing/welcome page
│   ├─ (auth)/         ← Login & Sign Up screens
│   ├─ onboarding/     ← 6-step setup flow
│   └─ (tabs)/         ← Main app (Home, Care, Log, Schedule, More)
├─ components/        ← Reusable buttons, cards, inputs
├─ convex/            ← Backend functions (database queries)
├─ hooks/             ← Shared React hooks
├─ lib/               ← Theme colors, spacing, fonts
├─ .env               ← Your Convex URL (don't share this)
├─ app.json           ← App name, icon, bundle ID
└─ package.json       ← List of all dependencies
```

You Made It!

If you followed every step, the app should be running on your simulator or phone right now. Go create a test account, run through onboarding, and explore every tab. Report any bugs or weird behavior — that's what testing is for!